and Arunachal Pradesh—is largely a product of conversions in the twentieth century. In Meghalaya, Christians made up just 6.16 per cent of the population in 1901. This went up to 24.67 per cent in 1951 and 74.59 per cent in 2011. Similarly, Mizoram had only 0.05 per cent Christians in 1901. By 1951, the state was almost entirely converted, with Christians making up 90.05 per cent of the population (down to 87.16 per cent in 2011). Nagaland was half-Christianised by 1951 at 46.05 per cent and almost entirely converted by 2011 (87.9 per cent). Arunachal Pradesh saw a different pattern, with conversions primarily occurring after 1971, when the area was brought under civilian control. The state had only 0.79 per cent Christians in 1971. By 2011, this proportion had gone up to 30.26 per cent.[137]

Opposition to the expansion of Christianity is a fundamental article of faith with the Sangh. Then RSS chief K.S. Sudarshan, speaking in Agra in 2000, accused Christian missionaries of using the Northeast to establish 'military bases' in 'strategic areas' to work against India. He argued that Christianity as it was practised in the region had 'more to do with politics and less with religion' and that 'Church politics is detrimental to the country'. As he put it, 'The Church has a special interest in the Northeast because it is a sensitive, border area and they wanted a base in strategic areas to establish military bases. All this is politics in the name of religion.' Sudarshan also floated the idea of a new 'Indian' church, asking Christians to set up an indigenous church, delinked from foreign churches, if they did not believe in 'anti-national' activities. This call for an indigenous Indian church is not very different from the RSS's call for Indianising Islam.[138]

Linking the church with foreign influences, especially in the context of the Northeast, is a recurring theme in Sangh literature. On the RSS's seventy-fifth anniversary Dashami speech in Nagpur, Sudarashan once again called on Christians to free themselves of 'divisive' foreign missionaries 'in particular in north east' who, he said, were encouraging 'extremism and separatism'. The church, in this view, was part of a 'foreign conspiracy' to destabilise India[139]—a view that goes back to Golwalkar. He had argued in *A Bunch of Thoughts*: 'Their [Christian] activities are not merely irreligious, they